

Ed called his credit card companies and asked each one to raise his credit limit. Some asked him why and some didn't bother to ask. Each one agreed to raise it. Doing this may not show a dollar savings at the time of the phone call, but improving the credit score helps all future dealings. And what is your plan for the future? To create wealth! Good credit can take you there. In fact, it can get you all the way to Millionaire Acres.

4. Call all your credit card companies and ask that they remove late fees.

This one is not a slam dunk. If it is your first late fee, you have a good chance that they will waive it. "Hello, this is Sue Jones. I see on my credit card statement that I was charged a late fee this month, and I have never been late, and I am hoping that it could be waived." If you have a good payment history with that card issuer, it is highly likely that they will waive the fee as a "courtesy." It was not so "courteous" of them to charge the fee in the first place, especially since you are such a good customer, but they do it. They do it all the time and they hope that you don't bother to ever look at your statement.

If you are perpetually late, all bets are off. But it never hurts to call. You never know for sure until you try, so explain that you mailed your payment on time and you have no idea how it could be late. For the first time that you make a late payment, it is definitely worth one phone call to save \$29 or \$39. In most cases, they should waive it. The odds go down with every late payment you make. Your pocket or theirs? You make the call.

Prior to reading this book, you probably assumed, as most people do, that one late payment is not a big deal. Now we know how the credit card companies pounce on that one late payment and try to use it to spin a web of fees. Now that we know, we won't give them the opportunity anymore. As unfair as it is, that one late payment can mean a late fee, an end to a good interest rate, and a trigger of universal default. So call and try to remove every late payment, and then stop making late payments. Pay on time. It really is in your best interest.